NUCLEAR NON-PROLIFERATION TREATY REVIEW CONFERENCE · NEW YORK · 2026

Gender audit of the 2026 NPT Review Conference

Matthias Dietrich

October 2026

1,131
Delegates accredited

66h 51m
Time on the floor

27 Apr – 22 May
Four weeks of debate

SPEAKING TIME · MEN 78% WOMEN 22%



dietrichm@protonmail.com

As you entered the United Nations (UN) headquarters during the Eleventh nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) Review Conference, you were greeted by portraits of the seven men who have served as Secretary-General, followed by an exhibit of twenty-four women who have shaped the organisation. The contrast between the portraits and the exhibit hints at an asymmetry in how the contributions of women and men are recognised within the UN.

The 2015 UN Global Study on the implementation of Security Council Resolution 1325 found that when women participate in a peace process, the resulting agreement is 20% more likely to last at least two years, and 35% more likely to last at least fifteen. Resolution 1325 itself, adopted in 2000, called for women's full and equal participation in peace and security, and a series of follow-on resolutions, among them 1820 and 2122, built the same principle into the UN's formal agenda. Women's participation is also integral to Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 5, gender equality.

In other words, the benefit of including women is established by evidence, not asserted by preference. With a dataset of 181 peace agreements as the basis for the Global Study, it is difficult to understand why such substantive research is so readily disregarded. At the NPT Review Conference, where states parties meet every five years to assess the implementation of the treaty, the floor remains dominated by men.

The following figures draw on the recorded shares of men and women within state delegations, as well as their speaking time and the number of times they took the floor throughout the conference. The dataset and a PDF version of this report are available to download for your own use.

FIGURE 01

Women's overall share of state delegations and speaking time

The participant total includes every named person in the participants list, including from the International Atomic Energy Agency, the United Nations system, and other intergovernmental organisations.



The NPT is the most subscribed-to international treaty dealing with nuclear weapons, with its parties drawn from the 193 UN member states and the two permanent observer states, the Holy See and the State of Palestine. The UN member states that have not joined the treaty are India, Israel, and Pakistan, which all possess nuclear weapons, and South Sudan. The Democratic People's Republic of Korea, which also has nuclear weapons, announced its withdrawal in 2003, but its status is contested among states parties, and the UN still counts it among the 191.

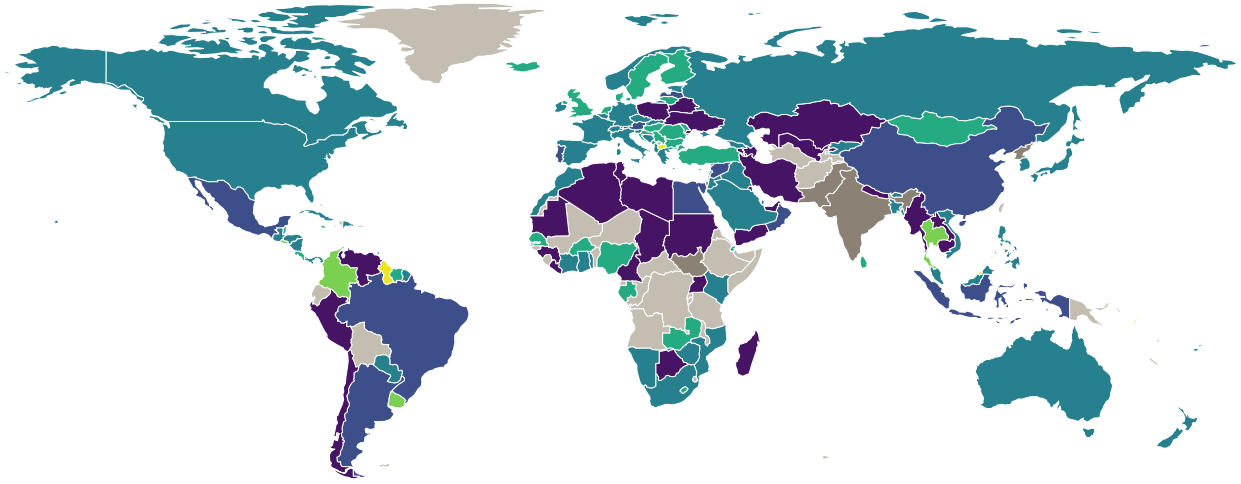
Adherence to the NPT is near-global, placing it among the most widely ratified international agreements, such as the Convention on the Rights of the Child, the Geneva Conventions, and the UN Charter. Its review conferences are a platform where nearly all UN members gather over a substantial period of time and have the opportunity to discuss and share views on central matters relating to international security.

FIGURE 02

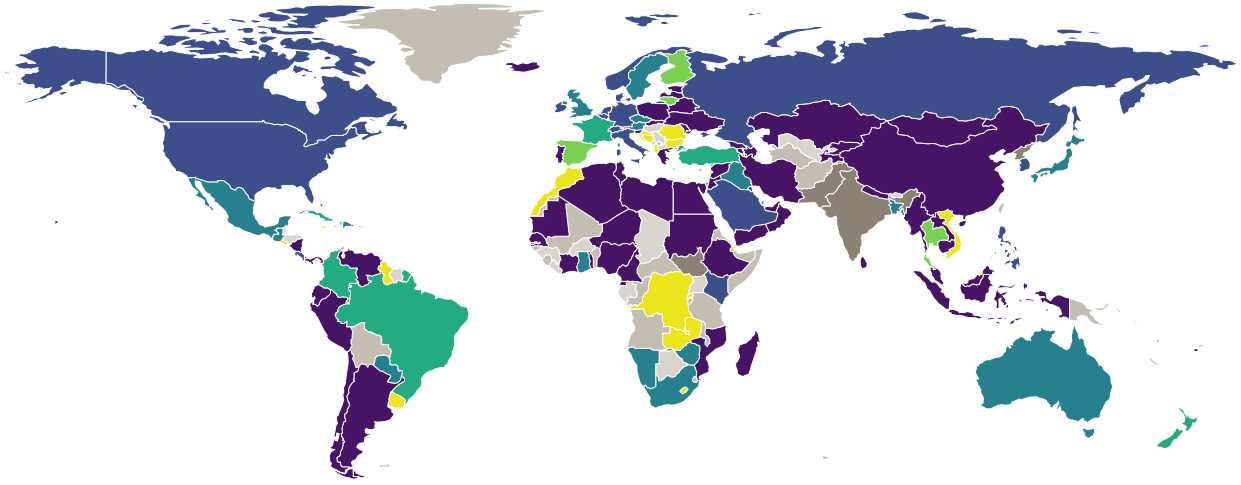
The gender map of the conference

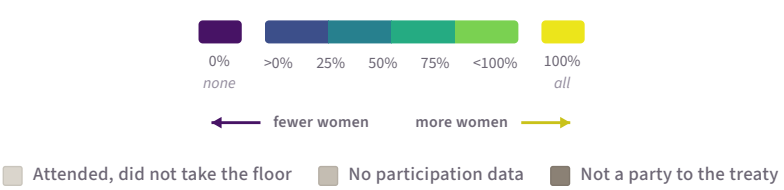
Grey marks states with no participation data, either because they sent no delegation on record or, in a few cases, because they took the floor without appearing in the participants list. Twelve small states are too small to appear at this scale and can be found in the list below.

DELEGATES Women's share of each state's delegates



SPEAKING TIME Women's share of each state's speaking time





Figures for every state are listed in the annex.

Brazil and Spain, despite having a majority of men among their delegates, saw women take up a large share of speaking time, at 60% and 82% respectively. By contrast Costa Rica and the Netherlands, with a majority of women delegates, fall into the lowest band of women's speaking time, at 17% and 18% respectively.

Nigeria and Senegal had gender parity among their delegates and took the floor 9 and 7 times, yet not once did a woman deliver the statement. Out of 20 states where only women spoke, 12 took the floor on a single occasion. Among the rest, El Salvador leads with 11 instances of taking the floor, followed by Bulgaria, Djibouti, and Uruguay at 4 each. Brazil and France took the floor 28 and 27 times, and in both cases 19 of those interventions were by a woman.

FIGURE 03

The delegations that took the floor the longest



Iran took the floor the longest, with Russia about 20 minutes and a single instance behind. That said, statements are delivered in one of the six official languages, namely Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian, and Spanish. Out of the top ten floor-takers, Brazil, Iran, and Japan delivered theirs in a second language.

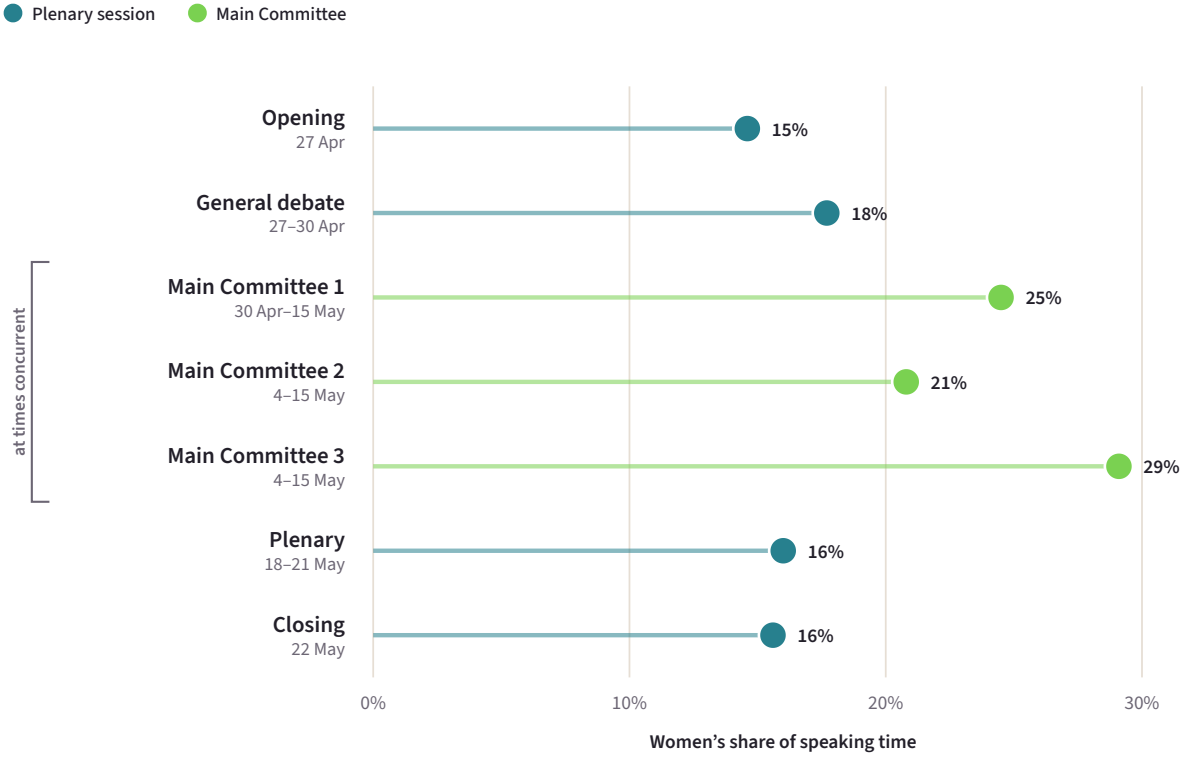
In political theory there is a debate about the quality of representation, which turns on two things. One is whether a person shares the experiences and characteristics of the people they speak for. The other is whether they advance those people's interests effectively. The two are not symmetrical. Shared experience and characteristics can come with effective advocacy, but effective advocacy cannot produce either.

This matters in a setting like the NPT Review Conference, where statements in plenaries and Main Committees are often drafted, edited, and read over by colleagues, or provided by the capital. That narrows the room for an individual to advance interests, as it means that statements delivered are not necessarily shaped by the person delivering them. As statements are taken to represent the official position of a whole state, those delivered at these high-level recorded meetings tend to be generic.

In turn it raises the importance of the visible aspect of representation. That visibility matters most in the high-level plenaries in the UN General Assembly (UNGA) Hall, but also in the other rooms, which see a constant flow of visitors, many of them school groups. The chance of a visitor seeing a woman speak is already low, as the overall figure showed, and lower still once you account for the conference president and the presidents of every Main Committee all being men. Between sessions, delegates break for coffee or lunch and informally engage with other participants. With fewer women in absolute numbers, there are also fewer women in those conversations.

FIGURE 04

Session by session

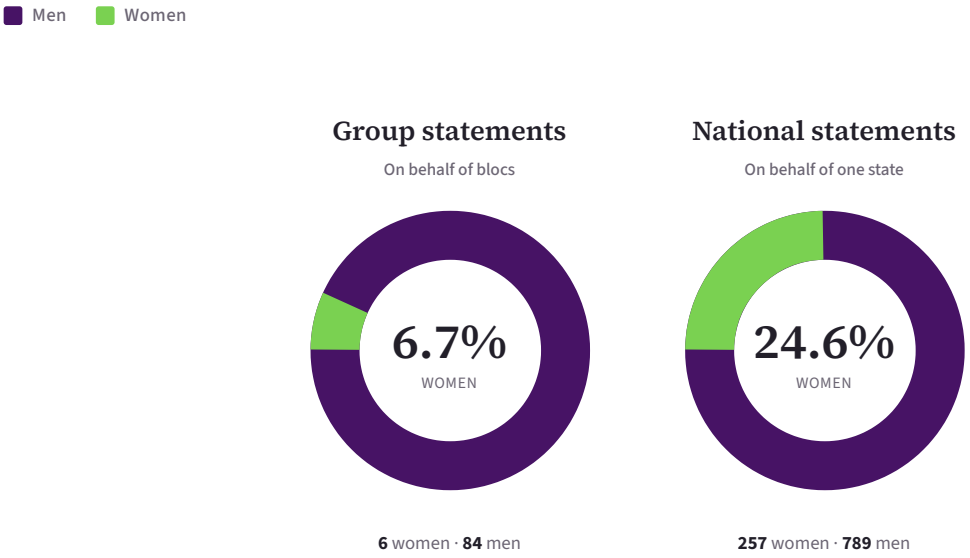


The gendered imbalance of speaking time runs deeper the higher the profile of the event. In the plenaries, held mostly in the UNGA Hall, women's share of the floor is lower. Their share is higher in the negotiating sessions, the Main Committees, held in the Secretariat building's chambers and smaller conference rooms.

Most delegations brought more men than women, and at times all three Main Committees ran at the same time. Women delegates, already outnumbered, were working across several rooms, yet they took a larger share of the floor there than in the plenaries, which sat one at a time.

FIGURE 05

Group vs. national statements

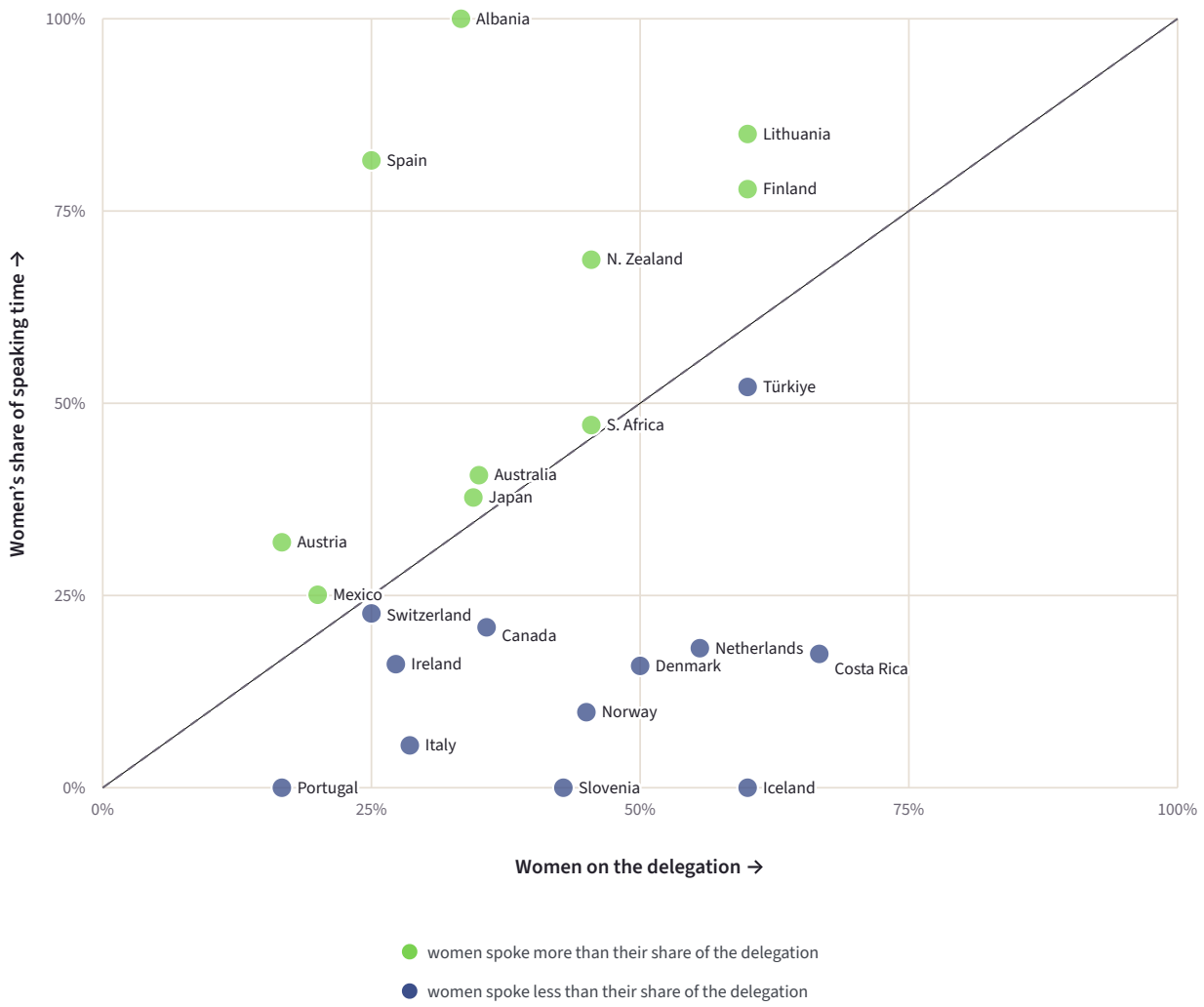


In groups, the share of women speaking drops by 17.9 percentage points compared to national statements. That is despite groups, by pooling several states together, holding a greater number of women among their participants than any single delegation. With the exception of the E3, every group that took the floor more than once did so without a single woman among its speakers – namely the African Group, Arab Group, ASEAN, AUKUS, Central Asia Nuclear Weapons Free Zone, European Union, GCC, NAC, and NAM. Twenty-four states signed the Joint Statement on Integrating Gender Perspectives in the NPT Review Cycle, each with a record of its own, laid out below.

FIGURE 06

Signatories to the gender statement

The dotted line marks equal shares of speaking time and delegates.



This is not a problem reserved to a specific group, region, or state. It is prevalent across delegations, persisting despite numerous statements affirming the meaningful role women play. This falls short of the unanimous commitments made by member states, with four years left to meet SDG 5. The seeming disregard of the 2015 Global Study is concerning, since the findings link the exclusion of women to agreements that are more likely to fail. The map and group figures show this is not for a lack of women in delegations, while the session figure shows that women's share of the floor falls in the high-level plenaries and rises in the working committees.

The UN General Assembly, now well underway, and the upcoming first Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons (TPNW) Review Conference follow the same format as the NPT Review Conference. Both put the decision to break this pattern in the hands of states. The next UN Secretary-General takes office on 1 January 2027. As reported by PassBlue, four of the seven candidates in the most recent straw poll were women, and the vote showed no clear winner. The commitment to gender equality has been made and the evidence is in. States now have the chance to make history by appointing the first woman to lead the UN.

Notes on methodology and next steps

The speaking time data is based on my own collection from UN Web TV recordings. As the data was entered manually, it may contain errors.

The participant data is taken from the participants list, NPT/CONF.2026/INF/6.

For speaking time, gender is based on the Mr and Ms titles recorded by Reaching Critical Will. For participant data, it is based on the titles in the participants list. Where no gendered title was available, gender is based on an online source giving a gendered title. In very few cases it is based on observed gender, as no other source was available.

Mr and Ms, and their equivalents and variations in other languages, only record two genders. This is a limitation in a gender study, as they do not reflect how a person identifies.

“Taking the floor” does not include routine procedural interventions such as the chair giving the floor.

The participants list shows who was accredited, not who sat where and when, or whether they attended at all. Nine states took the floor but do not appear in the participants list, namely Bahamas, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Ecuador, Equatorial Guinea, Ethiopia, the Marshall Islands, Niger, Rwanda, and Tajikistan.

The map shows territories without taking a position on sovereignty or self-determination.

Ideally this study would have included an element of age, but looking up the age of every participant was not realistic. Yet both gender and age are information the Secretariat already holds, since it registers everyone who joins the conference. Using this data and complementing it with time-stamped transcriptions, a study like this could become routine for every public open session. At almost no cost, this would track how meaningful representation of women and youth plays out in practice. The participant data is already produced, and the time-stamped transcription can be produced by transcription software, or for the cost of one person’s salary if done manually.

State by state

Every state in the participants list or recorded taking the floor, in alphabetical order. A dash means no record.

	DELEGATES			TAKING THE FLOOR			
STATE	TOTAL	WOMEN	WOMEN'S SHARE	TIMES	BY WOMEN	DURATION	WOMEN'S SHARE
Albania	3	1	33%	1	1	0:04:28	100%
Algeria	6	0	0%	12	0	0:46:49	0%
Andorra	3	2	67%	0	—	—	—
Argentina	10	1	10%	14	0	0:54:46	0%
Armenia	3	0	0%	1	0	0:05:09	0%
Australia	20	7	35%	20	6	0:47:39	41%
Austria	12	2	17%	18	5	0:53:47	32%
Azerbaijan	3	0	0%	2	0	0:06:21	0%
Bahamas	—	—	—	1	0	0:05:00	0%
Bahrain	6	3	50%	1	0	0:01:28	0%
Bangladesh	4	1	25%	2	1	0:07:39	43%
Belarus	2	0	0%	1	0	0:06:41	0%
Belgium	5	2	40%	16	3	0:41:34	19%
Belize	4	2	50%	0	—	—	—
Bhutan	3	1	33%	0	—	—	—
Bosnia and Herzegovina	7	3	43%	1	1	0:04:35	100%
Botswana	1	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Brazil	10	2	20%	28	19	1:11:50	60%
Brunei Darussalam	4	4	100%	1	1	0:04:03	100%
Bulgaria	3	2	67%	4	4	0:20:26	100%
Burkina Faso	4	2	50%	0	—	—	—
Cambodia	9	0	0%	4	0	0:11:27	0%
Cameroon	4	0	0%	23	0	1:33:44	0%
Canada	14	5	36%	21	4	1:00:29	21%
Chad	2	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Chile	3	0	0%	4	0	0:15:33	0%
China	19	2	11%	33	0	1:50:26	0%
Colombia	4	3	75%	4	3	0:17:49	73%
Costa Rica	3	2	67%	9	1	0:29:47	17%
Côte d'Ivoire	5	2	40%	1	0	0:05:12	0%
Croatia	6	4	67%	2	2	0:08:14	100%
Cuba	8	3	38%	12	7	0:35:00	54%
Cyprus	5	3	60%	1	0	0:03:20	0%
Czechia	10	3	30%	3	1	0:11:45	43%
Democratic Republic of the Congo	—	—	—	1	1	0:00:49	100%
Denmark	6	3	50%	11	1	0:25:02	16%
Djibouti	2	1	50%	4	4	0:12:11	100%
Dominican Republic	3	1	33%	5	2	0:18:42	29%
Ecuador	—	—	—	1	0	0:04:48	0%
Egypt	11	2	18%	15	0	0:47:28	0%
El Salvador	4	3	75%	11	11	0:36:05	100%
Equatorial Guinea	—	—	—	5	0	0:03:54	0%
Estonia	7	3	43%	4	0	0:13:52	0%
Ethiopia	—	—	—	1	0	0:03:44	0%

STATE	DELEGATES			TAKING THE FLOOR			
	TOTAL	WOMEN	WOMEN'S SHARE	TIMES	BY WOMEN	DURATION	WOMEN'S SHARE
Fiji	5	2	40%	1	0	0:06:01	0%
Finland	15	9	60%	7	6	0:25:21	78%
France	29	14	48%	27	19	1:10:34	63%
Gabon	2	1	50%	0	—	—	—
Gambia	4	1	25%	1	0	0:05:24	0%
Georgia	4	1	25%	1	0	0:04:09	0%
Germany	25	11	44%	22	2	0:55:22	10%
Ghana	7	3	43%	4	1	0:18:01	29%
Greece	4	1	25%	5	0	0:14:33	0%
Guatemala	3	1	33%	2	1	0:06:42	43%
Guinea	2	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Guyana	3	3	100%	1	1	0:04:12	100%
Holy See	7	2	29%	8	0	0:29:31	0%
Honduras	3	1	33%	0	—	—	—
Hungary	6	4	67%	0	—	—	—
Iceland	5	3	60%	1	0	0:04:08	0%
Indonesia	13	3	23%	16	0	0:47:21	0%
Iran	9	0	0%	55	0	3:04:03	0%
Iraq	4	1	25%	10	3	0:39:04	26%
Ireland	11	3	27%	10	1	0:32:03	16%
Italy	7	2	29%	11	1	0:39:39	6%
Jamaica	3	2	67%	1	1	0:05:26	100%
Japan	29	10	35%	29	9	1:23:54	38%
Jordan	5	2	40%	1	0	0:04:56	0%
Kazakhstan	9	0	0%	8	0	0:25:07	0%
Kenya	9	3	33%	4	1	0:19:30	24%
Kiribati	3	1	33%	5	4	0:17:58	82%
Kuwait	3	0	0%	4	0	0:18:10	0%
Kyrgyzstan	3	1	33%	3	0	0:12:41	0%
Lao People's Democratic Republic	3	0	0%	1	0	0:03:37	0%
Latvia	6	1	17%	3	0	0:11:28	0%
Lebanon	4	2	50%	2	2	0:09:12	100%
Lesotho	4	2	50%	1	1	0:01:59	100%
Liberia	3	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Libya	1	0	0%	4	0	0:13:19	0%
Liechtenstein	6	3	50%	1	0	0:05:13	0%
Lithuania	5	3	60%	10	9	0:33:22	85%
Luxembourg	6	2	33%	1	1	0:04:46	100%
Madagascar	1	0	0%	6	0	0:18:04	0%
Malaysia	11	3	27%	10	0	0:40:09	0%
Maldives	7	3	43%	1	1	0:03:33	100%
Malta	6	4	67%	1	1	0:04:39	100%
Marshall Islands	—	—	—	1	0	0:06:05	0%
Mauritania	2	0	0%	1	0	0:05:37	0%
Mauritius	5	3	60%	0	—	—	—
Mexico	10	2	20%	24	4	1:02:58	25%
Monaco	1	1	100%	0	—	—	—
Mongolia	2	1	50%	1	0	0:05:30	0%
Montenegro	2	1	50%	0	—	—	—

STATE	DELEGATES			TAKING THE FLOOR			
	TOTAL	WOMEN	WOMEN'S SHARE	TIMES	BY WOMEN	DURATION	WOMEN'S SHARE
Morocco	4	1	25%	1	1	0:04:53	100%
Mozambique	4	1	25%	4	0	0:16:51	0%
Myanmar	3	0	0%	1	0	0:06:13	0%
Namibia	8	2	25%	7	3	0:27:08	47%
Nepal	4	0	0%	8	0	0:25:12	0%
Netherlands	18	10	56%	19	3	0:37:34	18%
New Zealand	11	5	46%	9	6	0:33:37	69%
Nicaragua	3	1	33%	1	0	0:04:50	0%
Niger	—	—	—	1	0	0:03:23	0%
Nigeria	4	2	50%	9	0	0:34:13	0%
North Macedonia	2	2	100%	0	—	—	—
Norway	20	9	45%	16	2	0:57:21	10%
Oman	11	1	9%	4	0	0:16:33	0%
Panama	4	1	25%	1	0	0:03:32	0%
Paraguay	5	2	40%	2	1	0:06:49	48%
Peru	6	0	0%	8	0	0:29:17	0%
Philippines	8	2	25%	17	1	0:35:10	11%
Poland	10	0	0%	10	0	0:33:15	0%
Portugal	6	1	17%	4	0	0:18:16	0%
Qatar	6	2	33%	5	2	0:15:09	51%
Republic of Korea	18	7	39%	14	3	0:46:54	8%
Republic of Moldova	4	2	50%	1	0	0:04:54	0%
Romania	7	5	71%	2	2	0:09:38	100%
Russian Federation	29	11	38%	54	1	2:44:09	3%
Rwanda	—	—	—	2	2	0:08:10	100%
Saint Vincent and the Grenadines	4	4	100%	0	—	—	—
Samoa	3	0	0%	1	0	0:04:37	0%
San Marino	2	1	50%	1	1	0:04:50	100%
Saudi Arabia	19	5	26%	11	1	0:37:04	9%
Senegal	4	2	50%	7	0	0:27:39	0%
Serbia	8	4	50%	0	—	—	—
Singapore	7	4	57%	9	6	0:28:43	51%
Slovakia	10	3	30%	1	0	0:06:26	0%
Slovenia	7	3	43%	3	0	0:10:28	0%
Solomon Islands	3	3	100%	0	—	—	—
South Africa	11	5	46%	27	17	1:12:14	47%
Spain	8	2	25%	7	6	0:26:58	82%
Sri Lanka	4	2	50%	4	0	0:17:55	0%
State of Palestine	4	2	50%	5	4	0:23:14	71%
Sudan	3	0	0%	1	0	0:07:20	0%
Suriname	3	2	67%	0	—	—	—
Sweden	20	11	55%	12	5	0:38:16	31%
Switzerland	8	2	25%	13	3	0:43:23	23%
Syrian Arab Republic	5	1	20%	2	0	0:11:18	0%
Tajikistan	—	—	—	1	0	0:03:35	0%
Thailand	7	6	86%	13	11	0:44:36	78%
Timor-Leste	2	0	0%	1	0	0:05:51	0%
Togo	3	1	33%	3	0	0:12:52	0%
Trinidad and Tobago	3	2	67%	0	—	—	—

STATE	DELEGATES			TAKING THE FLOOR			
	TOTAL	WOMEN	WOMEN'S SHARE	TIMES	BY WOMEN	DURATION	WOMEN'S SHARE
Tunisia	3	0	0%	1	0	0:04:31	0%
Türkiye	15	9	60%	9	4	0:30:42	52%
Uganda	5	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Ukraine	4	0	0%	11	0	0:37:29	0%
United Arab Emirates	2	0	0%	11	0	0:32:40	0%
United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland	38	19	50%	27	5	1:09:31	25%
United States of America	34	16	47%	40	10	1:43:29	22%
Uruguay	6	5	83%	4	4	0:19:13	100%
Uzbekistan	2	0	0%	0	—	—	—
Vanuatu	5	3	60%	1	0	0:05:40	0%
Venezuela	4	0	0%	1	0	0:05:44	0%
Viet Nam	9	3	33%	1	1	0:05:23	100%
Yemen	3	0	0%	3	0	0:13:51	0%
Zambia	3	2	67%	3	3	0:14:27	100%
Zimbabwe	14	6	43%	9	2	0:34:13	25%

NO PARTICIPATION DATA · 18

Afghanistan, Angola, Benin, Bolivia, Burundi, Central African Republic, Congo, Eritrea, Eswatini, Guinea-Bissau, Haiti, Malawi, Mali, Papua New Guinea, Sierra Leone, Somalia, Turkmenistan, United Republic of Tanzania

NOT A PARTY TO THE TREATY · 5

Democratic People's Republic of Korea (contested), India, Israel, Pakistan, South Sudan